

TINY GUILD

Game Design Document

Desktop Idle RPG / Guild Management / Character-Driven Companion Game

Version 0.2 - Character & Relationship Expansion
September 2026

Core Fantasy

Build a tiny adventurer guild that lives above your taskbar while you work, study or play - and gradually fall in love with the heroes living inside it.

1. Executive Summary

Tiny Guild is a Windows desktop idle RPG in which a small fantasy guild lives directly above the taskbar. Heroes automatically travel, fight, gather resources, discover loot and return home while the player focuses on management, buildcrafting, progression and character relationships.

Version 0.2 expands the original economy and progression design with a named ensemble cast. Characters are not interchangeable stat blocks: each has a visual gimmick, personality, relationship network, recurring dialogue patterns and event chains. The intent is to make players care about what happens to the cast as much as they care about stronger equipment.

Design Goal

The player should alternate between two impulses: “Did I get stronger?” and “What are these idiots doing now?”

2. Product Definition

Field	Definition
Platform	Windows PC
Engine	Godot 4
Genre	Idle RPG / Auto Battler / Guild Management / Collection
Presentation	Small borderless always-on-top desktop world above the Windows taskbar
Art Direction	Cozy fantasy pixel art; expressive silhouettes; readable at small scale
Primary Session	Passive 30+ minute background play with 30-second to 3-minute check-ins
Secondary Session	10-30 minute management, buildcrafting, boss and collection sessions
Monetization Direction	Premium game first; no real-money gambling. Arcane Machine uses earned in-game currency only.

3. Core Design Pillars

Living Desktop

The game should feel like a tiny world living on the player’s computer rather than a conventional window.

Idle, Not Empty

Progress continues passively, but player decisions about party composition, skill trees, equipment and expedition choice meaningfully alter efficiency.

Collection & Surprise

Heroes, equipment, relics, pets, cosmetics, journal entries, rare variants and random events create constant reasons to check back.

Build Diversity

Classes support multiple viable specializations instead of a single obvious optimal path.

Character Attachment

Named heroes develop friendships, rivalries, affection and recurring jokes. Relationships create both gameplay bonuses and fandom fuel.

Cozy Spectacle

Most moments are calm, but rare drops, bosses and jackpots are highly readable and satisfying even in the tiny desktop format.

4. Core Gameplay Loop

1. Choose heroes, equipment and an expedition objective.
2. Heroes travel automatically through the desktop world.
3. Combat, gathering and random encounters resolve in real time.
4. Heroes earn XP, Gold, materials and equipment.
5. The party returns to the Guild and generates character interactions.
6. The player equips, sells, dismantles or crafts loot.
7. Gold and meta resources unlock skill nodes, buildings and new regions.
8. Stronger builds access harder expeditions and rarer rewards.
9. New relationship scenes, jokes and pair dynamics emerge as heroes spend time together.

5. Session Design

Session	Length	Player Action	Purpose
Passive	10 min - hours	Mostly watches; optional active events	Background progression and desktop companionship
Check-in	30 sec - 3 min	Loot, skills, expedition, Arcane Machine	Frequent satisfying decisions
Management	10 - 30 min	Buildcrafting, crafting, boss planning, relationships	Strategic depth and collection
Return Session	After offline period	Review away report and story snippets	Re-engagement and reward summary

6. World & Guild Structure

The Guild Town is the persistent home hub. As buildings level up, the desktop world visibly becomes denser and more alive.

- Guild Hall - roster, party management and account progression
- Blacksmith - upgrade, forge and dismantle equipment
- Arcane Machine - slot-like earned-currency loot machine
- Tavern - recruitment, social scenes and rumors
- Training Ground - passive XP and practice events

- Alchemist - temporary expedition buffs and consumables
- Library - hero and global skill trees
- Expedition Board - missions, bounties and region selection

7. Regions

Region	Level	Enemies	Boss	Narrative Role
Whispering Forest	Lv. 1-10	Slime, Bat, Mushroom, Wolf, Goblin	Ancient Treant	Bright cozy forest; first relationships and running jokes begin.
Crystal Mine	Lv. 8-20	Cave Bat, Crystal Slime, Mole, Goblin Miner, Stone Golem	Crystal Guardian	Vertical cave silhouettes, crystals, risk/reward resource runs.
Forgotten Ruins	Lv. 18-30	Skeleton, Ghost, Mimic, Necromancer, Fallen Knight	The Forgotten King	Darker atmosphere; character backstory events and first serious conflicts.

8. Main Character Roster

The initial cast is deliberately small and strongly characterized. Three are available early; three enter as progression unlocks. Each hero has a combat identity, visual silhouette and social function inside the ensemble.

8.1 Mimi - The adorable disaster wizard

Combat Role	Mage - Fire / Arcane
Visual Identity	Oversized purple witch hat, slightly too-long sleeves, star-shaped hair clip, tiny floating spellbook. Her casting animations are beautiful; her idle animations are chaotic.
Personality	Cheerful, curious, impulsive, kind and slightly scatterbrained. Mimi is genuinely talented but has the survival instincts of a curious house cat. She touches cursed objects because “they looked lonely.”
Narrative Hook	Mimi joined the Guild to become a “great legendary mage,” but has no clear definition of what that means. Beneath the comedy, she is unusually sensitive to magical anomalies and may be connected to the late-game Astral Realm.

Signature Gimmicks

- Sometimes casts a harmless cosmetic spell on herself by accident.
- Collects mushrooms despite repeated warnings.
- Names slimes she does not intend to kill, then feels bad when the party kills them.
- Rare idle animation: falls asleep over her spellbook and levitates a few centimeters.

Gameplay Identity

High magic damage, elemental combos and burst. Can spec into Fire, Frost or Arcane chaining.

Relationship Role

Kael is visibly softer around her; Luna is her closest friend and chief instigator; Celeste acts exasperated but quietly mentors her.

8.2 Kael - The wall that secretly has feelings

Combat Role	Knight - Guardian / Crusader
Visual Identity	Dark steel armor, long muted-blue cape, clean silhouette, large shield. Rarely over-animates; every action looks deliberate.
Personality	Quiet, disciplined, patient and intimidating to strangers. He almost never raises his voice. He expresses care through actions rather than words and is terrible at explaining his own feelings.
Narrative Hook	Former royal guard who left after an event he refuses to discuss. The Forgotten Ruins reveal pieces of his past.

Signature Gimmicks

- Automatically steps between Mimi and suspicious objects during idle scenes.

- Keeps repairing Mimi's damaged hat without mentioning it.
- When Mimi is downed, his temporary "Composure Broken" combat buff can trigger.
- Very rare smile animation that the UI does not acknowledge.

Gameplay Identity

High defense and party protection. Guardian focuses on mitigation; Crusader on team buffs; a later Vanguard branch adds counterattacks.

Relationship Role

Strong slow-burn affection toward Mimi, never forced into explicit romance early. Respects Luna but hates being teased by her. Competitive history with Rowan.

8.3 Luna - The observant menace

Combat Role	Ranger - Sniper / Poison
Visual Identity	Forest-green cloak, compact bow, feathered hair accessory, expressive eyebrows. Often sits on environmental props instead of standing normally.
Personality	Confident, mischievous, socially perceptive and fiercely loyal. Luna notices everyone's feelings before they do and weaponizes this information for entertainment.
Narrative Hook	A traveling hunter who intentionally avoids talking about her family. Her humor hides strong abandonment fears.

Signature Gimmicks

- Looks directly at Kael after Mimi says something accidentally romantic.
- Has contextual "I saw that." dialogue.
- Steals food from party campfires, then blames nearby wildlife.
- Can discover secret paths more often than other heroes.

Gameplay Identity

Fast ranged DPS. Sniper focuses crits; Poison focuses damage-over-time; Hunter specializes in boss and monster-type bonuses.

Relationship Role

Mimi's best friend. Constantly teases Kael about Mimi. Has a playful rivalry with Finn and surprising emotional understanding with Rowan.

8.4 Rowan - The loud rival with a good heart

Combat Role	Knight - Berserker / Vanguard
Visual Identity	Red scarf, battered armor, oversized two-handed sword, visibly more animated than Kael.
Personality	Competitive, blunt, dramatic and deeply dependable. Claims everything is a contest, including breakfast.
Narrative Hook	Joined specifically because he heard "that boring knight Kael" was here. Their history initially sounds hostile but is

	eventually revealed to be based on mutual respect.
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Signature Gimmicks

- Challenges Kael to pointless competitions.
- Loses at quiet activities with impressive consistency.
- Pretends not to like cute creatures; pets approach him constantly.
- Gets embarrassed by sincere compliments.

Gameplay Identity

Aggressive frontline bruiser. Damage increases at lower HP; Vanguard branch rewards perfect blocks and counterattacks.

Relationship Role

Rival/brother dynamic with Kael. Luna enjoys provoking him. Celeste is the only person who can make him immediately stop shouting.

8.5 Celeste - The elegant mage who is tired of everyone

Combat Role	Mage - Frost / Support
Visual Identity	White-and-blue robe, small crystalline staff, immaculate posture, floating snowflake familiar.
Personality	Elegant, intelligent, dryly sarcastic and secretly nurturing. She presents herself as above the Guild's nonsense while continually cleaning up after everyone.
Narrative Hook	Former academy prodigy who became disillusioned with institutional magic. She recognizes unusual traits in Mimi's magic.

Signature Gimmicks

- Freezes spilled drinks instead of wiping them.
- Corrects Mimi's spell notation, then adds encouraging notes in tiny handwriting.
- Can silence an argument by entering the room.
- Her familiar visibly judges Rowan.

Gameplay Identity

Control and support mage. Slows enemies, creates shields and amplifies elemental effects.

Relationship Role

Mentor/older-sister energy with Mimi. Mutual respect with Kael. Rowan is inexplicably intimidated by her. She and Luna trade deadpan gossip.

8.6 Finn - The golden-retriever adventurer

Combat Role	Ranger - Hunter / Trickshot
Visual Identity	Warm brown leather, orange scarf, light crossbow, utility belt full of questionable gadgets.
Personality	Optimistic, friendly, enthusiastic and occasionally too

	trusting. The person who can accidentally turn a dangerous expedition into a picnic.
Narrative Hook	Grew up reading exaggerated adventurer stories and is thrilled to finally be inside one. Over time he learns that heroism is less glamorous and more compassionate than the books suggested.

Signature Gimmicks

- Brings snacks to boss fights.
- Tries to befriend monsters with mixed results.
- Celebration animation lasts slightly too long.
- Keeps a notebook rating dungeon food from 1 to 10.

Gameplay Identity

Mobile ranged DPS with chain shots, traps and monster-family bonuses.

Relationship Role

Friendly rivalry with Luna. Hero-worships Kael at first. Mimi loves his stories; Celeste fact-checks them.

9. Relationship & Fandom System

Relationships are designed to create attachment, memes and fan interpretation without making romance mandatory or locking major combat power behind a specific ship. The game provides chemistry, recurring motifs and optional scenes; the community is free to interpret them.

9.1 Relationship Axes

Axis	Range	Meaning	Gameplay Effect
Bond	0-100	Trust gained through shared expeditions and events	Small duo bonuses and event unlocks
Affinity	Hidden / contextual	How naturally two personalities enjoy each other	Dialogue weighting; not a player-controlled romance meter
Rivalry	0-5	Competitive tension	Challenge events and conditional combat buffs
History Flag	Boolean / staged	Shared backstory revelations	Unlocks story scenes and special dialogue

9.2 Key Pair Dynamics

Pair	Dynamic	How It Appears	Design Intent
Mimi + Kael	Slow-burn affection / protective comedy	Kael quietly protects Mimi; Mimi trusts him completely but often misses his obvious softness. Their strongest moments are small actions rather than declarations.	Fans can read it romantically long before the game confirms anything. Optional late-game scenes may deepen the relationship, but no

			mandatory romance route.
Mimi + Luna	Best friends / chaos duo	Luna encourages Mimi's curiosity until it becomes dangerous, then helps fix the consequences.	High-frequency banter and shared treasure events.
Kael + Luna	Deadpan victim vs professional teaser	Luna is one of the few people willing to openly call out Kael's feelings. Kael responds with silence, sighs and tactical retreat.	Comedic camp scenes; no major stat dependency.
Kael + Rowan	Rival brothers	Constant contests hide deep trust. Rowan forces Kael to be less emotionally sealed-off.	Duo counterattack and rivalry challenge events.
Mimi + Celeste	Chaotic student / reluctant mentor	Celeste criticizes Mimi's technique but recognizes extraordinary potential and becomes protective of her.	Magic research events and spell variants.
Luna + Finn	Competitive friends	Archery competitions, exploration bets and mutually escalating nonsense.	Travel-speed and discovery bonuses.
Rowan + Celeste	Loud man / one raised eyebrow	Rowan can argue with a dragon but immediately behaves when Celeste looks at him.	Strong comedy pair; occasional defensive synergy.
Celeste + Kael	Quiet mutual respect	Both are restrained and competent, making their dialogue unusually calm compared with the rest of the party.	Higher rest efficiency on difficult expeditions.

9.3 “Ship Bait” Design Rules

- Use recurring behavior rather than exposition: Kael repairs Mimi's hat; Mimi saves him a seat; Luna notices before either comments on it.
- Never interrupt the idle loop with compulsory romance scenes. Relationship moments should be short, optional or naturally integrated into returns from expeditions.
- Keep chemistry asymmetric and imperfect. Characters misunderstand each other, tease each other and occasionally disagree.
- Avoid making one interpretation the only valid one during early and mid game. Strong bonds can be romantic, platonic or rivalry-driven depending on pair.
- Combat bonuses from relationships should be modest enough that players are not forced to use a preferred pairing.
- Rare context-sensitive lines should reward observant players and create shareable screenshots.
- No paid relationship outcomes; no monetized affection meter.

Example Micro-Scene

Mimi: “Kael, do you think this mushroom is poisonous?”
 Kael: “Yes.”
 Mimi: “How can you tell?”
 Kael: “Because you are holding it.”
 Luna, from off-screen: “He has learned.”

9.4 Relationship Event Triggers

- Complete 5 / 15 / 30 expeditions together.
- Survive a boss fight with both characters below 20% HP.
- One hero rescues another from a downed state.
- Equip a lore-linked item while a specific companion is present.
- Return to the Guild during rain, night or seasonal events.
- Witness a rare monster or secret room together.
- Character-specific quest milestones.

9.5 Character Dialogue System

Dialogue is short enough to be readable in a taskbar-sized presentation. Most interactions are two to four lines and use weighted context tags rather than fully random chatter.

Context Tag	Example Trigger	Possible Output
LOW_HP	Kael and Mimi return injured	Kael: “You are resting.” / Mimi: “We are resting?” / Kael: “You are.”
RARE_LOOT	Luna finds Epic item	Luna: “I found this.” / Finn: “Where?” / Luna: “Where you didn’t.”
RAIN	Guild idle weather event	Celeste creates a tiny ice umbrella; Rowan complains it is too small.
MIMI_MUSHROOM	Mimi obtains mushroom material	Party members react differently based on relationship flags.
KAEL_SMILE	Very rare idle event	Luna silently points at Kael; screenshot-friendly moment.

10. Hero Progression & Skill Trees

Each hero has a deterministic class tree funded primarily by Gold. Major nodes may additionally require Guild Tokens so passive Gold farming cannot instantly unlock an entire build.

10.1 Example - Ranger Tree

Rapid Fire -> Quick Hands / Sharp Arrows -> Double Shot / Critical Eye -> Master Hunter

- Level 1 node: 250 Gold
- Level 2: 750 Gold
- Level 3: 2,000 Gold
- Level 4: 5,000 Gold
- Level 5 / major node: 15,000 Gold + optional Guild Token

10.2 Global Guild Skill Tree

Branch	Early Nodes	Mid Nodes	Capstone
Economy	Gold Gain	Sell Value, Offline Gold	Treasure Broker
Adventure	Travel Speed	Encounter Rate, Secret Chance	Pathfinder
Combat	Party Attack	Crit Chance, Boss Damage	Elite Hunter
Loot	Rare Drop	Extra Affix	Mythic Hunter
Social	Bond Gain	Event Frequency, Rest Dialogue	Found Family

11. Economy & Currencies

Currency	Source	Primary Uses	Design Role
Gold	Kills, expeditions, sales, quests, offline income	Skills, buildings, crafting, Arcane Machine, upgrades	Main circulating currency
Guild Tokens	Bosses, milestones, weekly goals	Major global nodes, high-tier buildings	Slow meta progression
Arcane Essence	Dismantling items, rare events	Enchanting, rerolls, high-tier Arcane Machine	Turns unwanted loot into value
Relic Shards	Bosses and secret encounters	Relic crafting and endgame recipes	Rare deterministic chase currency

11.1 Gold Sinks

- Hero skill nodes
- Guild buildings
- Crafting and forging
- Arcane Machine spins
- Equipment enhancement
- Affix rerolls
- Recruitment fees
- Inventory expansion
- Expedition preparation and optional boosts

Economy Rule

Gold should never become meaningless. Every major progression layer needs at least one recurring Gold sink.

12. Arcane Machine

The Arcane Machine is a slot-machine-inspired loot feature located in the Guild. It uses only earned in-game currencies. Its purpose is anticipation, animation and item discovery - not real-money gambling.

12.1 Base Rarity Odds

Rarity	Example Base Chance
Common	55%
Uncommon	25%
Rare	13%
Epic	5%
Legendary	1.8%
Mythic	0.2%

12.2 Pity & Fairness

- 20 spins without Epic+ -> next qualifying spin guarantees Epic or better.
- 100 spins without Legendary -> Legendary guarantee.
- Mythic progression also produces fragments so extremely unlucky players still advance.
- All probabilities are visible in the UI.
- No premium currency is required to spin.

12.3 Symbol Combinations

Combination	Reward Bias	Presentation
Sword / Sword / Sword	Weapon guaranteed	Forge sparks
Shield / Shield / Shield	Armor guaranteed	Shield slam
Gem / Gem / Gem	Epic+ guaranteed	Crystal burst
Mushroom / Mushroom / Mushroom	Random mushroom-themed item	Mimi runs into frame
Skull / Skull / Skull	Curse Chest: high variance	Lights briefly go dark
Star / Star / Star	Jackpot: Legendary or Mythic	Whole desktop world pauses for celebration

12.4 Character Reactions to the Machine

- Mimi presses the button with both hands and celebrates before the reels stop.
- Kael claims it is inefficient, but is occasionally caught using his free spin when nobody is watching.
- Luna tries to predict the result and insists she was “basically right.”
- Rowan shouts at the machine as if louder input changes probability.
- Celeste knows the exact math and is unimpressed by superstition.
- Finn has a ritual that becomes increasingly elaborate despite having no effect.

13. Itemization

- Slots: Weapon, Helmet, Armor, Boots, Ring, Relic
- Rarities: Common, Uncommon, Rare, Epic, Legendary, Mythic

- Affixes: Attack, Attack Speed, Crit Chance, Crit Damage, elemental damage, Boss Damage, Gold Find, Rare Drop, Movement Speed
- Legendary and Mythic items should alter behavior, not merely increase numbers.

13.1 Example Unique Items

Item	Rarity	Unique Effect
Slime King's Crown	Legendary	Every 20th eligible enemy has a chance to become a Golden Slime.
Moonlight Staff	Legendary	Every third spell repeats at reduced power.
Goblin's Lucky Coin	Legendary	+25% Gold gain, -8% damage.
Mimi's Singed Hat	Mythic Cosmetic/Relic	A story reward; improves Arcane event chance and adds exclusive dialogue.
Kael's Old Guard Emblem	Relic	Protection skills can trigger a small party heal after a rescue.

14. Crafting, Dismantling & Enchanting

- Common items can be fused upward or dismantled for Essence.
- Materials plus monster-specific drops create deterministic target recipes.
- Unused loot remains valuable through dismantling.
- Affix reroll consumes Essence and preserves the item's identity.
- Enhancement levels increase stats; milestone levels can add visible cosmetic changes.

15. Expedition System

- Normal - balanced XP, Gold and loot
- Resource Hunt - materials
- Treasure Hunt - item-focused
- Boss Hunt - targeted boss access
- Mystery Expedition - unknown event distribution
- Endless Expedition - continues until party retreat conditions are met

Party composition also changes social outcomes. Sending the same pair repeatedly increases Bond and unlocks pair-specific camp dialogue, but diminishing returns prevent one pairing from being mechanically mandatory.

16. Active Desktop Events

- Golden Slime - optional click for bonus Gold
- Treasure Goblin - short chase for a chest
- Falling Star - temporary buff or Stardust resource
- Lost Familiar - choose which hero investigates; may unlock dialogue
- Guild Argument - short social event with no punitive outcome
- Mushroom Emergency - Mimi-specific recurring comedic event

Non-Intrusion Rule

Missing an active event must never create a meaningful progression penalty. The game lives beside the player's

work; it should not demand attention.

17. Quests, Journal & Achievements

- Daily quests: short objectives such as defeating 50 Slimes.
- Weekly quests: expedition milestones and boss targets.
- Character quests: narrative chains tied to each hero.
- Monster Journal: kill counts, discovered drops, variants and notes.
- Achievements mix progression milestones with comedy and character-specific secrets.

17.1 Example Achievements

Achievement	Condition
First Blood	Defeat the first monster.
Slime Problem	Defeat 1,000 Slimes.
Lucky Bastard	Obtain a Legendary from the Arcane Machine.
Touch Grass	Accumulate 24 hours of run time.
Please Stop	Defeat 100,000 Slimes.
He Smiled	Witness Kael's rare smile idle animation.
Do Not Let Her Cook	Trigger three Mimi mushroom events in one day.

18. Offline Progression & Rest

When the game opens after downtime, it calculates bounded offline progress and displays a concise “While You Were Away” report: monsters defeated, Gold, items, rare drops and one or two character snippets.

- Base maximum offline progress: 4 hours.
- Guild upgrades raise the cap to 6, 8, 12 and eventually 24 hours.
- Energy is a soft efficiency system, not a hard stop. At zero energy heroes continue at reduced efficiency.
- Rest scenes are one of the main places for relationship dialogue and visual comedy.

19. Prestige / Legacy

Late game unlocks Guild Rebirth. The player resets much of Gold, hero levels and regional progression in exchange for Legacy Points.

- Permanent Gold bonus
- Permanent XP bonus
- Rare loot chance
- Offline efficiency
- Additional hero trait capacity
- Arcane Machine luck / pity improvements
- Social branch: increased Bond gain and additional ambient event slots

20. First 10 Minutes

Time	Event	Purpose
0:00	Kael appears in the desktop strip; first Slime approaches.	Demonstrate living desktop and auto combat.
1:00	First Gold drop.	Introduce economy.
2:00	Rusty Sword drops.	Introduce equipment.
3:00	Equip tutorial.	First meaningful optimization.
5:00	First Skill Tree node.	Show Gold sink and progression.
6:30	Mimi joins and accidentally interrupts Kael's idle routine.	Introduce character identity.
7:00	Golden Slime event.	Show optional active event.
8:30	First Kael/Mimi micro-interaction.	Signal relationship system.
10:00	Free Arcane Machine spin; guaranteed Rare.	End onboarding with spectacle and loot.

21. UI & Presentation

- Default world strip stays minimal: hero sprites, nearby enemies, Gold, level and current region.
- Clicking a hero opens a compact profile panel with equipment, traits, skill branch, Bond summary and recent event log.
- Relationship information is descriptive rather than a dating-sim heart meter. Example: “Kael trusts Mimi deeply” instead of “Romance 73/100.”
- Rare events temporarily expand presentation height only when necessary, then collapse back to the desktop strip.

22. Visual & Audio Direction

- Pixel art with 24x24 or 32x32 hero sprites for stronger facial/body readability.
- Every main hero requires Idle, Walk, Attack, Hit, Downed, Sleep, Celebrate and at least two personality-specific animations.
- Coins bounce; Legendary drops glow; Crits pop clearly without visual clutter.
- Ambient audio remains quiet by default because the game may run all day.
- Separate volume controls: Ambient, Combat, UI, Events.

23. MVP Scope

23.1 MVP Includes

- Heroes: Kael, Mimi, Luna; Rowan/Celeste/Finn can enter immediately after MVP or as stretch content.
- Regions: Whispering Forest, Crystal Mine, Forgotten Ruins.
- 5-8 base enemies and 3 bosses.
- Approximately 30 items.

- Auto combat, XP, levels, Gold, loot, inventory, equipment, hero skill trees, global skill tree, Arcane Machine, expeditions, save/load, offline progression.
- Basic relationship system with Bond, contextual dialogue and 10-15 micro-events.

23.2 Post-MVP

- Full six-character social network
- Pets
- Advanced crafting
- Prestige
- Seasonal content
- Guild customization
- Large-scale character quest chains
- Additional regions and classes

24. Technical Architecture

Recommended Godot 4 structure:

```
res://
core/ - game_manager, event_bus, save_manager
systems/ - combat, loot, economy, expedition, progression, offline, relationship, dialogue, arcane_machine
entities/ - hero, enemy, pet
data/ - heroes, enemies, items, zones, skills, dialogue, relationships
ui/ - HUD, inventory, skill tree, Arcane Machine, guild, hero profile
world/ - guild, forest, mine, ruins
effects/ - particles, damage numbers, drop celebrations
assets/ - sprites, portraits, audio
```

24.1 Character Data Model

Each HeroData resource should separate mechanical data from presentation/personality data.

```
HeroData
id / display_name / class_id
base_stats / growth_curve / skill_tree_id
traits / preferred_roles
portrait / sprite_set / animation_set
personality_tags
dialogue_profile_id
relationship_preferences
story_flags
signature_event_ids
```

24.2 Relationship Data Model

```
RelationshipState
hero_a_id / hero_b_id
bond_value
rivalry_level
event_flags[]
shared_expeditions
rescue_count
bosses_survived_together
last_interaction_timestamp
```


25. Data-Driven Content Rules

- Do not hard-code item tables, dialogue pairs or event thresholds into combat scripts.
- Dialogue entries use context tags, relationship requirements, cooldowns and weights.
- Character reactions should be easy to add as data without editing the core simulation.
- Astra tasks should add one system at a time and run a dedicated test scene before touching adjacent systems.

26. Development Order

10. Taskbar window prototype: transparent / borderless / always-on-top positioning.
11. Kael movement + Slime spawn + auto combat.
12. Gold + XP + leveling.
13. Basic loot and inventory.
14. Mimi joins; add first character-specific idles and two Kael/Mimi interactions.
15. Hero skill tree and Gold sinks.
16. Arcane Machine with visible odds and pity state.
17. Expedition system and return report.
18. Luna joins; introduce three-character relationship context.
19. Save/load and offline progression.
20. Crystal Mine + boss.
21. Polish, balance and onboarding.
22. Add Rowan, Celeste and Finn after the core loop is proven.

27. Definition of “The Game Is Working”

Playable Milestone

The player launches the game, sees Kael walking above the taskbar, watches him defeat a Slime, receives Gold and XP, equips a drop, sees Mimi arrive and create a short character interaction, spends Gold on a skill, then performs an Arcane Machine spin. If that 10-minute experience is charming without requiring constant clicking, the core concept is validated.

28. Long-Term Fantasy

The player begins with one serious Knight and a nearly empty wooden Guild. Dozens of hours later the taskbar strip has become a lively miniature fantasy neighborhood: heroes cross paths, pets follow them, buildings evolve, friendships and rivalries have history, rare equipment changes silhouettes, and the player recognizes every character from a single idle animation.

The strongest retention fantasy is not merely “my numbers are bigger.” It is: “this is my Guild, these are my idiots, and I know exactly what each of them is going to do.”

29. Updated Unique Selling Proposition

USP

A cozy idle RPG where a tiny adventurer guild lives above your Windows taskbar - fighting, looting, growing and developing relationships while you do other things.